

What We Fixed Today

Chatswood Chase Valet App — Bandwidth & Reports Fixes — 9 August 2026

1 Photos Were Taking Up Too Much Space

THE PROBLEM

When staff took a photo (shopping bags or a car at check-in), the photo was saved **directly inside** the car's record in our database. A normal record is small — about the size of a text message. A record with a photo in it was 100–250× bigger.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

The app re-downloads the most recent 2,000 car records every time it refreshes — and this happens many times a day, on every device. Right now that's fine. But if the hands-free shopping service gets busy (say, 100 photo trips a day), those big photo records would fill up **all 2,000 slots within about 3 weeks**. After that, every single refresh would download hundreds of megabytes instead of a few — burning through our internet data budget very fast, the same kind of problem that caused the 7 August spike.

HOW WE FIXED IT

Photos now go into their own separate storage area (like a filing cabinet just for photos), and the car's record only keeps a short link to it. Every record stays small and fast, no matter how many photos we take. If the phone has no signal, it still works — it just saves the old way until it can connect again.

2 Old Reports Could Quietly Go Missing Data

THE PROBLEM

Each device only keeps the **most recent 2,000 cars** loaded and ready. Anything older automatically drops off to make room.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Once we pass 2,000 cars total, downloading a report or CSV for an **older date** could quietly leave cars out — with no warning. The report would still look normal, just be wrong, and nobody would know until the numbers didn't add up.

HOW WE FIXED IT

Reports now check first: "do I already have everything for this date range?" If something's missing, the app goes and fetches it straight from the database before building the report. Reports and exports are now always complete and correct, no matter how far back you go. Everyday use of the app (the live dashboard) wasn't changed at all — still just as fast as before.

Both fixes are already live on the app. Next step: try downloading a report on shift and confirm the numbers look right.